



CELL PHONES

This year has witnessed a host of new technologies in the cellular cosmos. While the beginning of the year saw a lot of improvement in the basic GSM cellular services, towards the latter half of the year, many of the big service providers introduced new, more advanced functionality in cellular services such as always-on Internet connectivity and new standards such as CDMA and MMS. While we are gripped at the cusp of this explosive growth, it is only testament to the fact that the forthcoming year will put the world in your palm, via your cell phone. With service providers ramping up their technology, it follows naturally that the Indian market will be flooded with new cellular devices that support these technologies and services—we are already seeing the first trickle with GPRS and MMS-capable cellular phones.

Make the right call

Various factors are instrumental when you go out to buy a cellular phone. At its very basic level, every cellular device in the market lets you make and receive calls, work with SMS and provides basic scheduling and contact management functionality. Depending on personal preferences, one would either need as many functions and features the phone has to offer with the price being no bar, or one would require basic functionality, with the price being a crucial aspect.

If you intend buying a new cell phone in the new year, look for a combination of basic functionality and support for future standards and services. Along with considering the traditional factors such as memory for contacts and messages, long battery life, scheduling, calendar and PIM functionality, you should also demand higher specifications in each of these. Set your sights on a phone that offers storage for at least 250 phone numbers, greater memory for storing SMS, and standby and talk time in excess of 15 days and 5 hours, respectively. Even in the lower end phones, you should ensure that there is some form of basic PIM functionality such as scheduling and reminder capabilities. Also, it is a wise choice to go in for a phone based on Lithium Ion batteries as they feature long talktimes and useable life.

On a higher plane, you should also look at more advanced features that will let the phone adapt to newer technologies. Bluetooth compliance is one such feature to look for. This wireless standard promises to deliver a transparent wire-free

Nominees

Name	Contacts	Comments
Nokia 5510	Nokia, Ph: 011-6779000	Boasting of a keyboard for e SMS entry and an in-built M player, this cellphone integr of functionality
Nokia 8310	Nokia, Ph: 011-6779000	With trendy looks, a large c memory and an integrated this phone delivered very g performance and functiona

experience when used with other Bluetooth-capable GPRS compliance and MMS functionality should also in mind for a better multimedia experience and for access to information on the Web. To facilitate all t phone will need a good screen with a relatively high re and preferably with colour support. Last but not t consider parameters such as weight, size and lool would, of course, depend upon your individual pr and personality!

If you want exclusive boasting rights, search f features such as backlit displays with many colou phonic ring tones and full-colour screens. Finally, al the phone and ask the vendor to demonstr of the features of the phone to you. Us while and see if it is comfortable to l operate, especially if you have large hands. Make and receive calls and see volume of the speaker is loud enough to hear clearly without having t yourself.



And the award goes to...

The cell phone that stood out f shoulders above this year's crowd of functionality, features and perf was the Sony Ericsson T68i. Fusi nology with great looks, this supports various standards such MMS and Bluetooth, and is a true of cellular phones to come. It k busy on long trips with eight ga

can hold 510 contacts, 150 messages and 30 calls. advanced Lithium Ion battery, it delivers a standby ti to 15 days and a talk time of over 6 hours on a sing session.

With its 256-colour screen, joystick menu na system and lightweight form factor, this phone g a surprisingly wide array of technology in a ve package.



Sony Ericsson T68i
Ericsson
Ph: 022-24962142

The verdict: With features like MMS and GPRS capability, a large phone and message memory and a full colour screen, this tiny cellphone packs a lot of technology into a small size